PAY·SCOPE

Know what your income is really worth.

MASTER WEBSITE ROADMAP

A location-aware financial intelligence platform for the Americas — combining income, taxes, take-home pay, local economics, housing, inflation, transportation and purchasing power into one personalized financial snapshot.

Working brand note: “PayScope” is already used by multiple existing salary/career products and domains. This document uses PayScope as the requested working brand, but a trademark/domain clearance should be completed before launch.

Product scope

Initial markets: United States • Canada • Mexico • Brazil

Future expansion: additional countries across the Americas and eventually other markets

1. Product Vision

PayScope is designed to answer one practical question:

> **“If I earn this much in this place, what does my life actually look like financially?”**

The product should not feel like a generic salary calculator. The salary/tax calculation is the entry point; the differentiating layer is the combination of local income context, live housing-market intelligence, cost of living, inflation, fuel and commute costs, and purchasing power.

Core user journey

Step	User question	Product answer
1	What do I earn?	Gross income, taxes and deductions
2	What do I actually keep?	Annual/monthly/weekly take-home
3	How am I doing locally?	Income and household benchmarks
4	What will life cost?	Cost of living + housing + transport
5	Where can I live?	Neighborhood rent/buy/room intelligence
6	What happens over time?	Inflation + purchasing power
7	What's left?	Estimated disposable / real income

Design principle

The interface must be calm and sequential in attention, not sequential in navigation. Users should see the major inputs on the first screen without signup, and the result page should reveal the most important financial insight first, followed by deeper context.

2. Homepage / First-Visit Experience

The first page should not be a multi-step wizard. Users should be able to see and enter the major options immediately, without creating an account.

Primary inputs

Input	Examples	Behavior
Country	United States, Canada, Mexico, Brazil	Controls currency, tax and data rules
Employment	W-2, 1099, T4, C2C, CLT, PJ	Only show relevant options by country
Income	$120,000 / $60 per hour	Support salary and rate-based input
Location	Austin, Toronto, Mexico City	Controls regional tax/economic/housing data
Household	Single / 2 adults + 1 child	Enables household context

Homepage UX requirements

- No mandatory signup or login for the main calculation.
- No unnecessary screens between input and calculation.
- Currency automatically follows country but can be changed for display.
- Country-specific employment choices replace irrelevant global options.
- Clear disclaimer that calculations are estimates and depend on assumptions/data freshness.
- One primary CTA: Calculate.

Visual direction

Minimal white interface, generous spacing, subtle blue/purple accents, restrained cards, clear typography and a single dominant CTA. Avoid dense dashboards on the first screen.

3. Country & Calculation Architecture

PayScope should be one platform with modular country engines rather than four separate products.

Market	Initial employment types	Key calculation layers
🇺🇸 United States	W-2, 1099, C2C, H-1B, salary	Federal/state/local tax, FICA, deductions
🇨🇦 Canada	T4, C2C, C2H, incorporated, self-employed	Federal/provincial tax, CPP, EI, deductions
🇲🇽 Mexico	Payroll, contractor, freelancer, self-employed	Country-specific income/payroll rules
🇧🇷 Brazil	CLT, PJ, freelancer, self-employed	Country-specific income/social rules

Versioned tax engine

Tax rules must be stored by country and tax year, with effective dates and source metadata. Do not hard-code tax thresholds inside UI components.

Suggested structure

countries → regions → tax_rules → payroll_rules → employment_types → calculation_versions

Every rule should record: source, effective date, tax year, last reviewed date, assumptions and calculation notes.

Currency engine

Calculate taxes in the local currency. Optional currency conversion should be a display layer, not the tax-calculation layer.

4. Results Dashboard

The attached dashboard concept is the visual foundation. Keep it clean, spacious and card-based, but reduce simultaneous cognitive load by creating a clear visual hierarchy.

Top hero

“Here’s your financial snapshot” + location + employment + salary + household.

Primary KPI row

Card	Purpose
Take-Home Pay	Most important result; annual net income
Monthly Take-Home	Immediate monthly planning number
Effective Hourly Rate	Take-home divided by annual work hours
Download Report	Optional PDF export / detailed breakdown

Secondary cards

- Take-home breakdown — taxes, payroll deductions and other deductions.
- Income vs local benchmark — position relative to selected local household/earnings data.
- Cost of living — monthly category estimates.
- Inflation & purchasing power — current inflation and future required income.
- Fuel & commute — current fuel price and estimated commute cost.
- Real income after expenses — disposable income after selected costs.

Attention hierarchy

Users should understand their take-home and disposable income before seeing advanced charts. Detailed breakdowns can remain one click away.

5. Housing Intelligence — Major Differentiator

Housing becomes a core part of the product because the user's income is meaningful only in the context of where they live and what housing costs there.

Housing modes

- Rent
- Buy
- Room / shared housing
- Student housing / dorms where reliable data exists

Property filters

- Studio, 1 bed, 2 bed, 3 bed, 4+
- Apartment, condo, townhouse, detached house
- Room/shared apartment/student housing

Top 5 neighborhood view

Neighborhood	1-bed rent	2-bed rent	Home price/value	Trend
Area 1	Typical/median	Typical/median	Estimated/median	↑/↓
Area 2	Typical/median	Typical/median	Estimated/median	↑/↓
Area 3	Typical/median	Typical/median	Estimated/median	↑/↓
Area 4	Typical/median	Typical/median	Estimated/median	↑/↓
Area 5	Typical/median	Typical/median	Estimated/median	↑/↓

Do not label every metric “average.” Use the correct source terminology: median asking rent, typical rent, estimated home value, median listing price, etc.

6. Dynamic Housing Market Data

Housing should be a living market snapshot rather than a static city average.

Market metrics

- Current rental listing activity where permitted by data source
- Active listings
- New listings
- Typical/median asking rent
- Home values / listing prices
- Inventory
- Days on market
- Month-over-month and year-over-year changes

Freshness UX

Every market card should display a timestamp such as “Updated today,” “Updated Aug 18, 2026,” or the relevant monthly/quarterly period. Never imply real-time data when the source updates weekly or monthly.

Data pipeline

Licensed/API/official data → ingestion → validation → normalization → deduplication/outlier handling → database → market metrics → website.

Important implementation rule

Do not build the production system around scraping websites whose terms prohibit it. Prefer official datasets, licensed feeds and permitted APIs. Track source, license/usage constraints and attribution requirements for every dataset.

7. Personalized Housing Affordability

The housing section becomes much more useful when it connects directly to the user's take-home income.

Example

Estimated take-home: $7,500/month
Neighborhood rent: $2,100/month
Housing burden: 28%

Possible classification

Indicator	Meaning
□ Comfortable	Within the user's selected housing budget
□ Stretch	Higher burden but potentially manageable
□ High burden	Housing consumes a large share of estimated take-home

Best-fit neighborhood engine

Rank neighborhoods using a transparent methodology that can incorporate housing cost, income, commute, fuel/transportation and household profile.

Example output

□ North Austin — good housing fit + moderate commute
□ Cedar Park — lower housing burden
□ Downtown — higher rent but shorter commute

8. Inflation & Purchasing Power

Inflation should be more than a single percentage. The product should show how inflation changes the user's required income over time.

Core outputs

- Current inflation rate
- Estimated personal inflation based on spending mix
- Income required in one year to maintain purchasing power
- 3-year, 5-year and 10-year purchasing-power projections
- Raise-vs-inflation analysis
- Required nominal raise for a target real-income increase

Personal inflation

Allow the user to allocate spending across housing, food, transport, healthcare, utilities and other categories. Use official CPI category data where available.

Key visual

A simple line chart comparing nominal income with inflation-adjusted purchasing power. Keep the chart visually light and avoid turning the page into a trading terminal.

9. Fuel & Commute Intelligence

Transportation should connect directly to the user's take-home pay and housing choice.

Fuel calculator

- Vehicle / fuel type
- MPG, km/L or L/100km
- Daily commute distance
- Workdays per week
- Weeks worked per year
- Current local fuel price
- Manual fuel-price override

Outputs

Metric	Example
Daily fuel	$4.28
Monthly fuel	$85.60
Annual fuel	$1,027.20
Share of take-home	X%

Expanded commute cost

Later include parking, tolls, maintenance, public transit and commute time. This enables an “effective work rate” or total commuting cost metric.

Road-trip mode

From → destination → vehicle → fuel/energy → distance → one-way and round-trip cost.

10. Real Income & AI Explanation

The platform's signature insight is the amount left after the user's selected taxes and living costs.

Real income calculation

Take-home pay − housing − transportation − selected living costs = estimated disposable income

Example

Take-home: $72,350/year → estimated living costs: $4,326/month → fuel/commute: $85.60/month → estimated disposable income: approximately $1,916/month.

Real Income Score

Optional proprietary score based on disposable income, housing burden, transportation burden, inflation and local context. It must be clearly labeled as PayScope's own planning metric, not an official economic statistic.

AI explanation

After calculation, generate a concise natural-language explanation of the results. AI should explain validated calculations and source-backed data; it should not invent tax rates, market prices or economic statistics.

11. Future Tools

Feature	Purpose
Job Offer Calculator	Compare compensation structures within the selected country
US W-2 vs 1099 vs C2C	Show estimated net outcomes and assumptions
Canada T4 vs C2C vs C2H	Employment-structure analysis
Brazil CLT vs PJ	Country-specific compensation comparison
Download Report	PDF summary of calculation, housing, inflation and assumptions
Saved Profiles	Optional accounts for returning users
EV vs Gas	Annual energy/commute cost comparison
Neighborhood Finder	Personalized area recommendations

Monetization

- Free core calculator supported by display advertising.
- Relevant affiliate partnerships where appropriate and clearly disclosed.
- Premium saved profiles, advanced projections and reports.
- Paid advanced job-offer/compensation analysis.
- Never require payment or signup before the user receives the core calculation.

12. Technical Architecture

Recommended stack

Layer	Recommended
Frontend	Next.js + React + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS
Charts	Recharts or another lightweight charting library
Animation	Framer Motion / CSS transitions
Backend	Next.js API routes or Node.js services
Database	PostgreSQL
Caching	Redis / edge caching where appropriate
Hosting	Vercel + managed PostgreSQL
Scheduled jobs	Server-side cron/queue for data refresh

Country-module architecture

Country → Region → Tax → Employment → Economic → Housing → Fuel

Suggested database entities

countries, regions, cities, neighborhoods, tax_rules, payroll_rules, employment_types, income_benchmarks, household_income, inflation_data, cpi_categories, housing_market, housing_listings, rental_data, home_values, fuel_prices, cost_of_living, data_sources, calculation_versions.

Privacy

- No account required for basic calculations.
- Minimize storage of salary, household and location information.
- If accounts are introduced, provide deletion controls and clear data policies.
- Do not sell users' personal financial inputs.

13. Data, Trust & Methodology

Because the product combines financial, tax and housing information, trust is a product feature.

Every major data point should expose

- Source
- Data period / effective date
- Last updated timestamp
- Whether the value is an estimate, median, typical value or asking price
- Relevant assumptions
- Calculation methodology

Source strategy

Prefer government sources for taxes, CPI and official income statistics; use licensed or permitted real-estate/market data sources for housing; use reliable fuel-price datasets for transportation.

Current brand-risk finding

As of this roadmap's preparation, "PayScope" is already being used online by multiple products. One PayScope site offers AI salary analysis and career tools, another offers U.S. salary data, and an older PayScope service is also visible. A PAYSCOPEMD trademark application was filed in the U.S. in December 2025 for employment-offer analysis software/services. This creates a meaningful naming/clearance risk for the planned financial-intelligence product.

Recommendation: treat PayScope as a working brand only until a qualified trademark professional and domain registrar confirm that the intended use is clear in the relevant jurisdictions/classes.

14. SEO & Content Architecture

The homepage should be the brand destination, while individual calculators target specific search intent.

US

/us/salary-calculator • /us/take-home-pay-calculator • /us/w2-calculator • /us/1099-calculator • /us/c2c-calculator • /us/h1b-salary-calculator • /us/inflation-calculator • /us/cost-of-living • /us/gas-cost-calculator • /us/commute-cost-calculator

Canada

/ca/salary-calculator • /ca/t4-calculator • /ca/c2c-calculator • /ca/c2h-calculator • /ca/incorporated-contractor • /ca/take-home-pay • /ca/inflation-calculator

Mexico

/mx/salary-calculator • /mx/income-tax-calculator • /mx/take-home-pay

Brazil

/br/salary-calculator • /br/clt-calculator • /br/pj-calculator • /br/take-home-pay

Location pages

Only create city/region pages when there is genuinely useful local data: taxes, income benchmarks, housing, inflation, fuel and cost-of-living context. Avoid mass-generated thin pages.

SEO content principle

The product should rank through useful calculators plus original methodology, local data context, transparent sourcing and regularly updated pages — not by stuffing generic keywords into templated pages.

15. Development Roadmap

Phase	Scope	Priority
1	Brand/UI foundation, homepage, country/currency, input system	MVP
2	US salary + W-2 tax engine + take-home dashboard	MVP
3	Canada T4 + federal/provincial tax engine	MVP
4	US 1099/C2C/H-1B + Canada C2C/C2H/incorporated	High
5	Income benchmarks, household context, inflation, purchasing power	High
6	Housing intelligence: top 5 neighborhoods, rent/buy/room	High
7	Dynamic housing-market data + affordability ranking	High
8	Fuel, commute, road-trip and EV tools	Medium
9	Mexico + Brazil country engines	High
10	Job offers, real-income score, AI explanation, reports	Medium
11	SEO expansion, city pages, analytics and growth	Ongoing

MVP definition

Launch with a polished US + Canada experience first. The core calculation must be accurate, transparent and fast. Add Mexico/Brazil after the country-module architecture is proven.

16. Final Product Blueprint

The final experience should feel like one calm financial story rather than a collection of calculators.

User flow

LAND → SELECT COUNTRY → EMPLOYMENT → INCOME → LOCATION → HOUSEHOLD → CALCULATE → FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT → HOUSING → TRANSPORT → INFLATION → PURCHASING POWER → REAL DISPOSABLE INCOME

The five questions PayScope must answer

Question	Product layer
What do I actually earn?	Income + taxes + take-home
How am I doing here?	Local and household benchmarks
What will life cost here?	Cost of living + housing + transportation
Where can I realistically live?	Neighborhood + affordability intelligence
What will my money be worth later?	Inflation + purchasing power

Brand statement

PAY·SCOPE

Know what your income is really worth.

Income • Taxes • Take-home • City • Housing • Inflation • Fuel • Purchasing Power

Build principle: the salary/tax calculator brings users in; the continuously refreshed local economic, housing and purchasing-power intelligence is what gives them a reason to return.

Brand clearance reminder

This roadmap intentionally uses “PayScope” because that is the name requested. However, current web research shows existing PayScope products and a U.S. PAYSCOPEMD trademark application. Do not purchase domains, file incorporation paperwork, launch publicly, or invest heavily in the identity until a formal trademark/domain clearance is completed.